



STRATEGY: INTERVIEW

over a five-year or longer horizon to design and launch products. For every ten software companies funded, at least one hardware company should receive support. Indian companies can also leverage the large domestic market to test and refine products before global expansion. This approach has not yet been fully utilised but offers a promising model for Indian firms.

SG: India is expected to leverage its nearly \$200 billion domestic electronics market. However, around 90% of this market is served by global product companies that decide on chip types outside India. How can India grow its electronics product companies and brands to create demand for local chips?

CM: The success of non-US chip design companies like MediaTek and Huawei illustrates the potential of focusing on electronics system-

level products. Huawei grew its chip design through its telecom and smartphone systems business, while MediaTek integrated itself into the global smartphone ecosystem. India should focus on emerging electronics products such as EVs and transportation to create leverage for domestic chip companies.

SG: If India aims to create one or two companies like MediaTek, what should be the strategy and focus areas?

CM: MediaTek's success stemmed from timing its investment in smartphones. For India to replicate this model, it should target different markets such as EVs and medical devices, leveraging its unique and large domestic market in transportation and healthcare. The application of AI to healthcare, wearable monitoring devices, and innovative medical equipment

presents significant opportunities for semiconductor innovation.

SG: Lastly, after semiconductors and AI, what could be the next global battleground where countries will seek supremacy, and would you consider authoring a book on it?

CM: Although I have not started a new book yet, I am interested in biotechnology and genetic engineering, particularly with the application of AI. Major innovations in these areas seem imminent. In 10-15 years, biotechnology and genetics could advance as significantly as chip technology does today. **EFY**

This interview was transcribed by Nidhi Agarwal, who is a journalist at EFY. She is an Electronics and Communication Engineer with over five years of academic experience. Her expertise lies in working with development boards and IoT cloud. She enjoys writing as it enables her to share her knowledge and insights related to electronics, with like-minded techies.

India's 1st Independent Survey



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